

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a report by a market research company:

Hong Kong people the most brand conscious in Asia Pacific

Hong Kong consumers are definitely among the quick adopters of fashion trends and are the world's most brand conscious, shown both by the increasing number of luxury brand stores opened in the city and also in our latest Global Luxury Brands Study.

Considered by many luxury groups to be a major market for their products, Hong Kong leads the Asia Pacific region with 40 percent of shoppers claiming to buy products of luxury brands, significantly exceeding the regional average of 15 percent.

As the global study reveals, Hong Kong tops the world in sales of luxury brands such as Gucci, Louis Vuitton, Ferrari, etc.

According to our on-going tracking of Hong Kong consumers' retail spending, an average of \$6,000 per person was spent on luxury products by people in Hong Kong in the past three months.

Hong Kong is considered by many international brands to be the major market in Asia. With the improving personal financial status of Hong Kong people and an increasing number of tourists who love to shop for luxury brands in Hong Kong, there is huge room for growth in the luxury sector.

Your group wants to gather information about the shopping trends for luxury brands in Hong Kong for a project. You may want to talk about:

- why international brands want to open stores in Hong Kong
- the advantages and problems this brings
- what other information to include in the project
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. What brands or products do you like?
2. Would you like to buy luxury brands?
3. Do you think luxury brands are too expensive?
4. Are luxury brands better than normal brands?
5. Do you think young people spend too much on luxury brands?
6. What products reflect Hong Kong's identity?
7. Do you think that local brands can compete with international brands?
8. What does the focus on luxury brands in Hong Kong say about Hong Kong people?